SHAHRAM AJLOO

Senior Electrical Engineer · MV, LV and ELV · delivery, review and commissioning · Copenhagen

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Senior Electrical Engineer · Electrical Engineering, Europe Region · Copenhagen (Axel Towers)

Application: Senior Electrical Engineer (COP00005M)

Dear Arup Copenhagen,

A cable schedule that is one circuit short does not fail on the drawing. It fails eleven months later, on a Friday, when the contractor has already pulled the cable. By then the shaft is closed, the variation is signed, and somebody has to decide whether the extra circuit goes through a riser that nobody designed for. The cost of that decision was set at the brief, when a load was taken as given.

That is why the design phases interest me, and it is also where I have to be straight with you: **I do not have eight years of consultancy design experience.** What I have is fifteen years of electrical and mechanical delivery on the other side of the drawing — as the client's engineer, the contractor's project manager and the owner of an electrical company — with a **Danish LV/MV/HV authorisation**, an **electrical engineering degree** behind it, and a habit of reading the design before the concrete is poured.

ARUP. Seventy-five years, more than **18,000 colleagues**, trust-owned, with a share of the profit rather than a quarterly number to defend. In Denmark: **Cityringen**, **BLOX**, the **Camp Adventure** tower — and a Copenhagen office in **Axel Towers** that has grown to **100+ people**. The three sectors in this role — **Mission Critical**, **Science & Industry**, **Healthcare** — are the ones where a **resilience** decision in the **brief** is expensive to change later, and where **redundancy** has to be argued rather than assumed — because the **stakeholders** are not one client but five.

The brief. Two questions decide most of the electrical **load**: what happens when the supply is lost, and who is allowed to notice. On a **healthcare** floor and in a **mission critical** hall the answer is different, and it changes the **transformer** size, the **switchgear** arrangement and the cost before a single line is drawn. I have spent four years on the receiving end of that answer, keeping a 24/7 plant running on HV and LV **switchgear** — and I know which of the two questions clients answer honestly.

Scheme design. The architecture of **MV, LV and ELV** is decided here: where the **transformer** stands, which **cable** routes are real, how the systems talk to each other, and where **coordination** with other disciplines is won or lost. My contribution is practical rather than ornamental — I have commissioned what others drew, and I know which of those decisions come back on site as a variation.

Detailed design. This is the phase I would grow into fastest and claim least: **calculations**, schedules, selectivity and discrimination, drawn and modelled to a standard someone else can build from. I work confidently with drawings, schedules and models as a reviewer and a user, and modelling is not my current authoring tool — I would learn the office's **BIM** workflow the way I learned the last three systems, by using it on a live package with someone checking my work.

Tender and contractor review. Here I am at home. Reviewing **contractors' design submissions, procedures and schedules** against the specification is what I did on **37 capital projects**, with **25 specialists** and a handover that had to survive an authority inspection: **zero critical findings**, every deviation closed with a name and a date. It is also the phase where **quality standards** are either enforced or quietly negotiated — and I have been the person who had to say no.

Installation and commissioning. This is the strongest part of my record: **FAT/SAT**, **testing**, **handover** documentation and the last week before energisation, when the **cable** is in, the panels are labelled and somebody has to prove the **redundancy** actually works. I have done that on installations that could not be allowed to fail, and I have written the **documentation** that the next engineer reads.

People and the skills network. I have led **14 people** in a contracting business, **5 electricians and 3 apprentices** in my own company, and 12 technicians before that. **Mentoring** was not a programme; it was a morning at the panel with somebody's drawing and a question. A **skills network** across an office is the same thing at scale, and I would contribute to the Danish one from the practical end: what the site does with the design, and what it costs when the design did not expect it.

Practical. I live in **Måløv**, 20 km from Axel Towers. **Danish** native, **English** professional — not Swedish or Norwegian. Available by agreement, and happy to be tested on a technical task before you decide.

Kind regards

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PROFILE

Electrical and mechanical engineer with a **Danish LV/MV/HV authorisation** and fifteen years of technical delivery: **37 capital projects** reviewed and handed over with zero critical findings, four years responsible for HV/LV **switchgear**, **transformers** and 24/7 supply, and an own electrical company since 2023. Strongest in contractor review, **commissioning** and **handover**; growing into design authoring.

ELECTRICAL DESIGN AND SYSTEMS

- **MV, LV and ELV:** Authorised for LV/MV/HV: switchgear, transformer stations, distribution boards, cable systems, earthing and the interfaces to ELV systems in operation.
- **Load and resilience:** Load profiles, redundancy and standby arrangements argued on four years of 24/7 operation — including what actually happens when the second supply does not come in.
- **Drawings and models:** Single-line diagrams, panel schedules and documentation read and reviewed daily; model review and coordination as a user, BIM authoring as the next skill to build.

DELIVERY, REVIEW AND COMMISSIONING

- **Contractor review:** Contractors' design submissions, method statements and schedules reviewed against specification on 37 projects; deviations closed with a name and a date.
- **Commissioning and handover:** Testing, FAT/SAT, handover packs and the week before energisation, on installations where failure was not an option.
- **Quality standards:** One checklist per discipline, applied to every site, so a review is repeatable and a quality finding does not depend on who is on holiday.

LEADERSHIP AND PEOPLE

- **Teams led:** 14 people in a contracting business, 5 electricians and 3 apprentices in my own company, 12 technicians earlier — plus 25 specialists coordinated across projects.
- **Coaching:** Mentoring at the panel rather than in a classroom: one drawing, one question, and the next task slightly harder than the last.
- **Standards and authority:** Design decisions explained to authorities and clients in writing; Danish installation rules as they are enforced on site, not only as they are written.

EXPERIENCE

Owner / Technical Director — ELOHVAC ApS · Copenhagen · May 2023–present

Scope: 5 electricians + 3 apprentices · full P&L · design-and-build quotations · installation delivery

- **Electrical work with a signature on it:** Quotations, load assessments and installation delivery for building owners — the part where the drawing meets the meter cupboard.

Senior Commissioning Engineer / Project Manager — Novo Nordisk A/S · Kalundborg / Bagsværd · Nov 2022–Jul 2024

Scope: 37 capital projects · 25 specialists · FAT/SAT · SAP · GMP/FDA/EMA documentation

- **Reviewing what others designed:** Contractor submissions, procedures and schedules checked against specification; commissioning and handover with zero critical findings.

Project and Workshop Manager — Ventek Air ApS · Vedbæk · Jan 2022–Nov 2022

Scope: 14 staff · 11 concurrent contracts · suppliers, subcontractors, own workshop

- **Eleven packages at once:** Scope, sequence and delivery across eleven simultaneous contracts — capacity moved before a bottleneck became a delay.

Head of Operations and Maintenance — Biofos (Lynetten) · Copenhagen · Aug 2017–Jan 2022

Scope: 24/7 plant · HV/LV switchgear, transformers, panels, SRO/SCADA · HSE and standby

- **The systems the design promised:** Switchgear, transformers and standby supply owned end to end — including the nights when redundancy had to prove itself.

Production Foreman / Electromechanical Technician — ARJ Engineering · Tehran · 2003–2010 · 12 mechanics and technicians

- **First leadership role:** Shift planning, allocation and training in a workshop where drawings and deadlines arrived the same morning.

EDUCATION AND AUTHORISATION

Electrical and Mechanical Design, Electrical Engineering (EQF 6) · Tehran Technical University · 2000–2003

B.Tech, Technology Management and Mechanical Engineering (EQF 6) · Copenhagen School of Marine Engineering & Technology Management · 2017–2022 · GPA 7.6/12

Danish electrician authorisation, LV/MV/HV — authorised mechanical engineer (maskinmester) · Danish Safety Technology Authority · May 2023

Lean: 5S, PDCA, VSM, A3 · refrigeration and HVAC technology (AMU) · STCW safety · Mercantec 2021 · Danish Maritime Authority 2021–2023

LANGUAGES, PRACTICALITIES AND REFERENCES

Danish: native · **English:** professional, written and spoken · **Persian:** native · Based in **Måløv**, about 20 km from Axel Towers · Available by agreement · References on request.

THE FIRST 90 DAYS — FROM BRIEF TO A REVIEWED PACKAGE

Period	What happens, and how it is measured
Week 1–2	Read three live packages end to end — one mission critical, one healthcare, one industry — and sit with the engineer who authored each. Ask which review comment saved the most money, and which one was ignored.
Day 30	One package reviewed independently, against the office's own checklist, with comments the lead engineer can accept or reject on the record. First pass on the BIM workflow, on a real model rather than a tutorial.
Day 60	Commissioning and handover experience written down as a short internal note: what the site needs from the design, and where the standard package leaves a question open. Shared with the Electrical Skills Network.
Day 90	Authoring a defined part of a package — schedules, calculations or a system section — under review, with the quality standard set by someone else and met.

A DESIGN IS ONLY AS GOOD AS ITS LAST REVIEW COMMENT

The visible product of a design office is a set of drawings; the actual product is a decision someone can build from. That is why the review matters more than the model: a comment that arrives before tender costs an hour, and the same comment after installation costs a variation, a delay and a client who remembers. I have been on the receiving end of both, and I write comments accordingly. **Sustainability** in a design is the same economy: the cheapest kilowatt is the one the building never needs.

THE SITE IS THE ONLY TEST OF A COORDINATION DRAWING

Coordination failures are rarely dramatic. They are a **cable** tray that is 80 mm too low, a panel that cannot open its door, a duct that arrives where a beam already is. None of it shows in a clash report; all of it shows in week nine. Having spent years on site, I read a model looking for the things that will be built, not the things that are drawn.

MISSION CRITICAL IS A SENTENCE IN THE BRIEF, NOT A BADGE

Redundancy on paper is easy: draw two feeds and write N+1. **Resilience** in reality is a maintenance procedure, a test schedule and a person who knows which breaker to open — and it fails quietly when nobody has planned the annual test. Four years of 24/7 operation taught me to ask for that plan before the design is frozen, not after.

COACHING IS HOW A STANDARD SURVIVES

A **quality** standard that lives in one senior engineer's head leaves when he does. The only version that survives is the one written down, used in every review and taught to the next engineer by doing it with them. That is what I would bring to a team of juniors and intermediates: a checklist they can argue with, and a review they have watched happen.

WHAT I WOULD NEED FROM THE OFFICE

Three things, and I would rather ask for them here than pretend otherwise: someone senior to check my first packages line by line, access to the standards library and the office's own templates, and a defined authoring scope so I am not learning in a corner. In return I bring a decade of site knowledge that makes a **review** comment useful before it becomes expensive.

WHERE I WOULD START

In the review. First month: three packages read end to end, one independent review against the office's own checklist, and the **BIM** workflow learned on a live model. Then the part I can add fastest — **commissioning** and **handover** knowledge turned into comments that arrive early enough to be cheap.

WHAT THE POSTING ASKS FOR — WHAT I HAVE	
Requirement in the posting	Evidence
Degree in Electrical Engineering	Electrical and Mechanical Design, Electrical Engineering (EQF 6, 2000–2003), plus B.Tech mechanical engineering and technology management (EQF 6, 7.6/12).
Minimum 8 years post-qualification design experience	Not met as a design-office record, and stated plainly in the letter. Fifteen years of electrical delivery sit behind it: 37 projects reviewed, commissioned and handed over.
Drive delivery of electrical design packages across the full lifecycle	Full lifecycle as client's engineer, contractor and owner: brief, installation, commissioning, handover — the phases where a design is proved.
Partner with architects, discipline experts, clients, contractors, authorities	Contractors and authorities as daily counterparts on 37 projects; architects and designers as counterparts in own design-and-build work.
Design medium voltage, low voltage and extra-low voltage systems in a BIM environment	MV/LV/HV authorisation and hands-on switchgear, transformer and cable work. BIM authoring is not my current tool; model review and coordination are.
Lead, challenge and coach a team of engineers	14 people in a contracting business, 5 electricians and 3 apprentices in my own company, 25 specialists coordinated across projects.
Set and uphold technical and quality standards	One checklist per discipline applied to every site; zero critical findings at handover on 37 projects.
Review contractors' design submissions, procedures and schedules	The core of my Novo Nordisk role: submissions, method statements and schedules checked against specification, deviations closed with name and date.
Communicate progress, risks and next steps to project management	Monthly status with risks and dates on 37 projects; in my own company, to clients who wanted to know before it hurt.
Mentor and develop junior and intermediate engineers	Mentoring at the panel with apprentices and technicians in every leadership role; competence plans written per person and followed.
Contribute to Arup's Electrical Skills Network in Denmark	Practical input from the site end: commissioning and handover lessons, Danish installation practice, and what a reviewed package needs to be buildable.
Help win new work through proposals	Quotations and technical proposals in my own company since 2023; scope, price and a delivery date that could be defended.
Deep knowledge of standards and regulations in Denmark and Scandinavia	Danish LV/MV/HV authorisation and work under the Danish Safety Technology Authority; installation practice as enforced on Danish sites. Deep design-standard knowledge is still being built.
Leading design teams on Science, Industry and Healthcare	Healthcare-adjacent and regulated production at Novo Nordisk (GMP/FDA/EMA) and a 24/7 utility plant; design-team leadership in a consultancy is the step I am applying for, not a claim I make.
English plus Danish, Swedish or Norwegian	Danish native, English at professional level, Persian native. No Swedish or Norwegian.
Passion for sustainable building design and excellent engineering	Energy management in Copenhagen with over 40 % lower consumption documented; Lean method work and a habit of choosing the cheaper, simpler installation.
Curiosity, ownership, building trust quickly, high-quality design	Owner of a company and of 37 deliveries: decisions taken, mistakes owned, and the lesson written into the next project.
Work in multidisciplinary project teams	Process, mechanical, ventilation and electrical disciplines coordinated on 37 projects; interfaces agreed in writing rather than assumed.
Mission Critical, Science & Industry and Healthcare projects	24/7 mission critical operation for four years, regulated production under GMP/FDA/EMA, and installation delivery in occupied buildings.